THE HEIRESS & HER LYING BEAST

ENG. Ver
04/15/2025

EPISODE 1

1 **INT - HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT** 1

SOPHIA LAWRENCE (20s, visibly drunk but beautiful, resilient) stumbles into the room, slams the door shut, and locks it. BAM! BAM! Someone pounds on the door.

THUG (O.S.)
Open up, you little brat! Don't make this hard!

SOPHIA
Tell that old hag she can forget about drugging me and shipping me off to marry that creep Leo!

ALEX (O.S.)
Excuse me? What are you doing in my room?!

Sophia spins around. ALEX CHRISTOPHER (late 20s, sharp, eyes unreadable) stands there—towel hanging low on his hips. She blinks. Her brain short-circuits.

SOPHIA
(blurted out)
Wow…Abs.

ALEX
(deadpan)
That's not an answer.

SOPHIA
Sorry, I—
(the alcohol hits, she sways, falling against him)

Alex steadies her.

ALEX
You okay?

SOPHIA
(murmuring, dazed)
Bad guys… trying to take me…

BOOM! The door flies open. Alex yanks Sophia into his arms.

ALEX
(to thug, cool as hell)
Get. Out.

The thug hesitates—then bails. Sophia tilts her head up, eyes hazy.

SOPHIA
(smirking, finger tracing his jawline)
My hero.

Alex opens his mouth to say something— but she kisses him.

ALEX
Do you even know who I am?

Sophia grins, tipsy and flirty.

SOPHIA
Mmm… a very, very hot guy.

She pulls him closer. Their fingers lace.

2 **INT - HOTEL ROOM - MORNING** 2

Phone ringing. Loud. Relentless. Sophia grunts, grabs it.

MR. LAWRENCE (V.O.)
Sophia! Get your ass up! You're having a date with the Christopher family member in an hour—DO NOT be late!

Sophia slowly sits up. Her head pounds. She looks around, sees the bed. The sheets. The unfamiliar room-She remembers. Her eyes go wide.

SOPHIA
(horrified, muttering to herself)
Oh. My. God. Did I just have a one-night stand… with a complete stranger?!

The shower shuts off.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
Shit! He’s coming out! What should I do?!

EPISODE 2

3 **INT - HOTEL ROOM - MORNING - CONTINUOUS** 3

Bathroom door creaks open.

Alex steps out—towel slung low, body cut like sin. He scans the room. Bed-A mess. Sophia-Gone.

On the table—a stack of hundred-dollar bills and a note, stamped with a red lipstick kiss.

Alex picks it up. Reads.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
Let's pretend it never happened. No hard feelings-last night was magnificent.

Phone rings.

Alex answers, still staring at the note.

ALEX
Yeah. I remember. The arranged date. I'll be there.

4 **INT - COFFEE SHOP - DAY** 4

Sophia sits at a trendy café, facing a mirror, fingers tracing the fake scar on her forehead.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
Let's see if Leo Christopher still wants to marry me now.

A chair scrapes loudly.

LEO CHRISTOPHER (Late 20s, entitled, overdressed, exudes arrogance) drops into the seat across from her. No greeting. Just a disgusted sneer.

LEO
You're Sophia Lawrence? Oh, God. That scar is hideous.

Sophia smirks, unbothered.

SOPHIA
(mock sympathy)
Same to you. You look worse than your profile pic. Like… a warthog with a trust fund.

Leo's smirk vanishes.

LEO
You think I want this marriage? Please.
(MORE)

LEO (CONT'D)
If your dad and stepmom hadn't begged me on their knees, I wouldn't have even bothered showing up.

Sophia's smile doesn't fade. But she notices something. Across the room—Alex. Relaxed. Amused.

Sophia stands. Walks over. And—KISSES ALEX. Slow. Deliberate.

Leo chokes on air.

Sophia pulls back. Turns to Leo, eyes flashing.

SOPHIA
(sweetly)
Well, thank you for stopping by. But I've already picked my groom.

EPISODE 3

5 **INT - COFFEE SHOP - DAY** 5

Leo scoffs, turning to Alex.

LEO
(mocking)
Is that so, Uncle?

Sophia snaps her head toward Alex. Alex meets her gaze, unreadable. Then, a slow, effortless smile.

ALEX
(calm, amused)
Leo, you're embarrassing the family. Is that how a Christopher treats his future aunt?

LEO
(laughs, obnoxious)
My apologies, my dear uncle. After all—you're crippled and she's—visually challenging. A match made in heaven.

ALEX
(leans forward, easy charm)
And you just lost a Beverly Hills mansion in Vegas. Maybe I should call your mother.

Leo freezes. Face drains.

LEO
Sorry, Auntie. Nice meeting you. Gotta go!

Leo bolts.

6 **INT - COFFEE SHOP - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 6

Sophia and Alex lock eyes.

FLASHBACK:

Last night. Heat. Hands. Skin. Sophia shakes it off.

END OF FLASHBACK

SOPHIA (V.O.)
No way. That guy knew what he was doing. There's no way he was a cripple!

Alex studies her.

ALEX (V.O.)
If it weren't for that scar, she'd be a dead ringer for the woman from last night…

Alex leans back, extending a hand.

ALEX
We never properly introduced ourselves. Alex Christopher.

Sophia takes his hand, firm shake.

SOPHIA
Your future wife.

Alex raises a brow.

ALEX
That desperate?

SOPHIA
More like destined, don't you think?

Alex chuckles.

ALEX
Terms?

SOPHIA
Contract marriage. One year. You help me reclaim my mother’s inheritance.

Alex tilts his head, considering.

ALEX
Fine. But I have a condition too.

EPISODE 4

7 **INT - LAWRENCE MANSION - DAY** 7

Sophia pushes open the door. Her father, MR.LAWRENCE (50s, with authority) sits on the couch, seething.

SOPHIA
Morning, Dad. You look thrilled to see me.

CRASH! He hurls his glass at the floor. From the grand staircase, SALLY LAWRENCE (30s, overdressed, under-qualified stepmother) and AMBER LAWRENCE (20s, overdressed, mean, Sophia's step sister) strut in.

SALLY
(fake concern)
Sophia! Leo just called. He says... you’re ugly and uncultured!

AMBER
(laughs, dripping venom)
Can’t blame him. If I were a guy, I’d puke just looking at you.

SALLY
(dramatic sigh)
No husband, no inheritance… and now you’re embarrassing the family name? Be useful for once, Sophia—leave the house.

Sophia smiles. Then grabs a teacup and hurls it straight at them.

SOPHIA (COOL, LETHAL)
This is my mother’s house. If anyone’s getting the hell out, it’s you—a bunch of freeloading parasites!

Glass shatters. Amber screeches, lunging. Sophia doesn't flinch. She grabs a pair of scissors, yanks Amber's collar, blade hovering at her neckline.

AMBER
DADDY, SHE'S LOST IT!

Mr.Lawrence rushes between them.

MR.LAWRENCE
Sophia! Your mother and sister are right! Get the hell out!

Sophia laughs. Loud. Dangerous. She reaches into her bag. Pulls out a document.

SOPHIA
About that…

She unfolds the paper, waves it like a winning poker hand.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Mom left me fifty percent of Lawrence Corp.

The room falls dead silent.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
So guess what, Daddy? That makes me the boss here.

EPISODE 5

8 **INT - LAWRENCE MANSION - DAY** 8

SALLY
No. That's impossible! Leo said—

SOPHIA
Who said Leo was my only option?

She whips out a marriage certificate.

AMBER
Alex Christopher? Who the hell is that?

SALLY
(scoffs, realization hitting)
Oh. That Christopher. The crippled one. Useless. A total disgrace to his family.

Sophia tilts her head, smirking.

9 **INT - EVEREST CAPITAL - DAY** 9

Alex stands at the window, sipping coffee, overlooking the city—no wheelchair in sight. William enters, dropping a folder onto the desk.

WILLIAM
(low-key excited)
Boss, we finally have a lead on the accident from five years ago!

Alex flips through the report, eyes narrowing.

ALEX
Took long enough. The second I have proof, Victor's finished.

WILLIAM
You spent years faking an injury, had the whole family thinking you were worthless, while building an empire from the shadows as X? That's not just revenge, boss. That's art.

ALEX
Blood for blood. No exceptions.

William flips another page, frowns.

WILLIAM
One problem—Victor's guys wiped the surveillance footage. No trace left.

Alex takes another sip of coffee, unfazed.

ALEX
There's always a trace.

He turns, finally meeting William's gaze.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Tell me—ever heard of Lawrence Corp?

William raises an eyebrow.

WILLIAM
Yeah… tech empire, owns SkyNet, the only system that can restore deleted data.

Alex lets the corner of his mouth lift.

ALEX
And guess who just took over as CEO?

EPISODE 6

10 **INT - LAWRENCE CORP - BOARDROOM - DAY** 10

Sophia stands at the head of the conference table, composed. She places a folder down.

SOPHIA
Per my mother's will, I'm officially stepping in as CEO of Lawrence Corp.

Board members murmur.

Mr. Lawrence pushes back his chair, arms crossed.

MR. LAWRENCE
Absolutely nonsense. Sophia has zero business experience. And frankly—that hideous scar on her face? Complete PR nightmare.

AMBER
(smirking)
And let's not forget—her husband is that useless cripple from the Christopher family. What exactly is he bringing to the table?

A few board members nod.

BOARD MEMBER #1
Sophia, the board has concerns about your leadership. There's no proof you're ready for this.

BOARD MEMBER #2
Unless... if you can land a contract with Everest Capital in three days, we'll reconsider.

SOPHIA
Consider it done.

11 **EXT - LAWRENCE CORP - DAY** 11

Sophia steps out—right into Amber and two female colleagues.

AMBER
Sophia, sweetie… Everest Capital is run by the most powerful man in the world—X. but the guy's practically a ghost! What makes you think you have a shot at getting in the room with him?

SOPHIA
Guess we'll have to find out.

COLLEAGUE #1
(laughs)
Sophia, please. X doesn't waste his time on nobodies!

COLLEAGUE #2
Unless... you're planning to spread your legs for him.

AMBER
Oh, please. Like she'd even hesitate. She's probably dreaming about it already—poor thing needs the attention!

Sophia grabs Amber's hair—yanks hard.

AMBER (CONT'D)
Are you fucking insane?!

HONK! A sleek luxury car rolls up. The tinted window lowers.

Alex sits inside—one arm draped lazily over the window frame.

ALEX
Damn, baby… watching you fight for yourself like that? Kind of a turn-on.

Sophia blinks. Amber and the others stand frozen.

EPISODE 7

12 **EXT. LAWRENCE CORP - DAY** 12

Alex leans against his car, looking effortlessly cool. He holds out a bouquet to Sophia. She takes it, barely masking her surprise. Amber and her colleagues gawk.

COLLEAGUE #1
Tell me I'm hallucinating. Did he just call her... baby?

COLLEAGUE #2
There's no way—no way—a guy like that would be interested in her!

Amber shoves past them, eyes locked on Alex. She slowly crosses her arms under her chest, pushing her cleavage up,, smiling sweetly.

AMBER
Not to sound rude or anything… but I just have to know—what do you see in her?

Alex tilts his head, smirking.

ALEX
Who should I be interested in then? You?

AMBER
She's married! Her poor crippled husband clearly isn't enough for her, so now she's playing you!

Alex chuckles, shaking his head.

ALEX
Huh. Well, if that's the case… I don't mind being played.

SOPHIA
Oh, where are my manners? Alex, meet Ashely—my father's illegitimate daughter.

Alex gives her a once-over, unimpressed.

ALEX
Ah. Now it makes sense. No class whatsoever.
(turns to Sophia)
Come on, sweetheart. Let's get out of here.

He opens the car door. Sophia slides in. Amber, shaking with fury, rushes to the car and pounds on the window.

AMBER
You hideous bitch! Who the hell do you think you are?!

Sophia slowly rolls down the window, unfazed.

SOPHIA
I'm the Bitch? Honey, the way you just threw yourself at my husband-that was embarrassing.

ALEX
Oh, right. Forgot to introduce myself properly. Alex Christopher. Sophia's husband. The cripple you were just talking about.

EPISODE 8

13 **EXT. ALEX'S ESTATE - NIGHT** 13

A luxury car pulls up to an opulent mansion.

Sophia steps out, eyes widening.

SOPHIA
Damn. This place is magnificent! I thought you were the least favored son in the Christopher family?

Alex smirks, effortlessly composed, reclining in his motorized wheelchair.

ALEX
Lucky for you. For the next year, this is your home, too. Contractually, of course.

14 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT** 14

A lavish dining table is covered with a spread fit. Sophia stares, utterly thrown.

Alex, wearing an apron, sets down a steak. He cuts a slice and slides the plate toward her.

ALEX
Medium rare. Thought you might like it.

SOPHIA
Okay… tell me you didn't secretly hire a private chef just to impress me.

ALEX
Glad you liked it. But trust me—cooking's just the beginning.

He lifts his wine glass, voice turning a shade more serious.

ALEX (CONT'D)
To you… my wife.

Sophia pauses, then smirks, lifting her glass.

SOPHIA
To business partnerships. And… my contract husband.

They drink. Then—

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(leaning back, tilting her head)
So… what's that one condition you mentioned?

ALEX
Patience, sweetheart. You'll know when it's time.

15 **INT. ALEX'S BATHROOM - NIGHT** 15

Steam billows through the air. Water runs down Alex's chest.

A soft knock. Then—the door cracks open.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
Alex, just a heads up—I'm coming in.

Alex's eyes snap open. He turns toward the door, startled.

EPISODE 9

16 **INT. ALEX'S BATHROOM - NIGHT** 16

The door swings open. Sophia steps in. Their eyes lock. Alex flashes his fake, businesslike smile.

ALEX
Didn't realize we were doing late-night visits, sweetheart. Shouldn't you be in bed?

SOPHIA
I was just thinking… bathing must be a little tricky for you. As your wife, I figured I should help.

ALEX
Appreciated, but I got this.

Sophia ignores him, rolling up her sleeves. Before he can stop her, she grabs the shower head, ready for action.

SOPHIA
Wait… you shower in the wheelchair?

ALEX
(deadpan, poker-faced)
It's waterproof. Top of the line.

SOPHIA
Well… alright then.

She awkwardly starts rinsing his back. As the water trickles down, she suddenly stops—Alex is still wearing his pants.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
So… you bathe with pants on?

ALEX
Baby, I know we are married, but stripping for you this soon? Feels a little… inappropriate. Don't you think?

SOPHIA
Come on, don't be shy-unless you plan on dry-cleaning your legs.

Alex immediately wheels back.

ALEX (QUICK, LAUGHING NERVOUSLY)
Yeah—no, we're not doing that.

Sophia steps forward, unfazed.

SOPHIA
Relax. I'm just being helpful.

As she leans in, her foot suddenly slips on the wet tile. She yelps—losing balance. Alex catches her mid-fall—arms instinctively wrapping around her waist. Sophia is now in his lap, face inches from his. Suddenly, the "scar" on her face wipes away.

ALEX
Your...your face—!

EPISODE 10

17 **INT. ALEX'S BATHROOM - NIGHT** 17

Sophia touches her face instinctively.

SOPHIA
(gasping, eyes wide)
Oh, hell.

She whirls to the mirror—her skin is flawless. Not a trace of the fake scar. Alex leans in slightly, his fingers brush against her cheek.

ALEX
(low, unreadable)
So this is the real you…

FLASHBACK - INT. HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT (Episode 1)

A darkened room. Tangled sheets. Heated kisses.

BACK TO PRESENT

Alex stares, his thumb lightly trailing her cheek.

ALEX (V.O.)
That night...It was you.

Sophia snaps out of it, pulling back.

SOPHIA
(rushed, defensive)
I wasn't trying to fool you! My stepmother and stepsister hated me growing up—tried to ruin me at every turn. This was the only way to survive.

Alex's thumb brushes against her cheek, his touch slow, deliberate. His gaze locks onto hers—intense.

ALEX
Shhh-You don't have to explain. I get it.

Sophia narrows her eyes, suspicious.

SOPHIA
Okay....why are you still looking at me like this? This is starting to feel weird.

Alex's lips curl into a smirk.

ALEX
Just thinking… we're already drenched. You still offering to help me with my bath?

Sophia's eyes flick to his throat—his collarbone—his very bare chest.

CLOSE-UP: Alex's abs. Water dripping down his toned body.

Sophia jolts back, laughing awkwardly, retreating toward the door.

SOPHIA
(nervous laugh)
Oh wow, look at the time—I totally forgot I have… things to do.

She slams the door shut behind her.

18 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP OFFICE - DAY** 18

Alex rolls inside, impossibly relaxed. Across from him, MR. CHRISTOPHER (mid-60s, stone-faced, expensive suit) holds a marriage certificate.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Who the hell gave you permission to get married?

THWAP! A stack of papers flies straight at Alex's head.

EPISODE 11

19 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP OFFICE - DAY** 19

Alex bends down, picking up the scattered papers off the floor.

ALEX
It's my marriage. My life. I don't need your approval.

Mr. Christopher pushes his reading glasses up, brow furrowing.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
You—! Ever since that accident, you've changed. You've—

His gaze flicks to Alex's legs. He doesn't finish the sentence.

ALEX
(mocking, low)
Go ahead. Say it-I'm a cripple!

ALEX (CONT'D)
But you know what? Even if I never walk again, even if I'll never be your favorite son, there are still women out there who know my worth.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
You still resent me, don't you? The board choosing Victor as heir—that was never my decision. All I ever wanted was for you two to look out for each other.

ALEX
Father, wake up. My dear half-brother wants me dead.

Mr. Christophe exhales, rubbing his temple.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
You always misjudge him… Fine. The marriage is done. At least treat your wife properly. And for God's sake, learn how to take a woman on a real date.

20 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - DAY** 20

Alex sits at his desk, flipping through reports. Across the room, William pours himself coffee.

ALEX
William, have you ever been on a date? I need some advice.

William nearly chokes on his coffee.

WILLIAM
Excuse me?! I'm a legendary playboy!

ALEX
Right. So tell me—how do you plan a date?

WILLIAM
Who's the lucky woman?

ALEX
My wife. Who else would it be? You?

WILLIAM
(teasing)
I mean, you could do worse.

Alex shoots him a look. William chuckles, clapping him on the back.

WILLIAM (CONT'D)
Relax, boss. Just stick with me—I'll turn you into a romance expert.

21 **INT. FINE-DINING RESTAURANT - NIGHT** 21

A lavish, candlelit table.

Sophia sits at the table as Alex gently covers her eyes with his hands.

SOPHIA
Alright, Mr.Mysterious. What's the big surprise?

EPISODE 12

22 **INT. FINE-DINING RESTAURANT - NIGHT** 22

Candlelight flickers. Sophia sits, eyes closed.

SOPHIA
(teasing)
Alex, I swear—if this is a prank, I'm walking out.

ALEX
Be patient. Five… four… three… two…

Alex lifts his hands from her eyes. Sophia's eyes widen at the candlelit table, the elegant setup.

SOPHIA
(mock suspicion)
Did you bribe someone for this?

Alex hands her a bouquet.

ALEX
Yes. They said I was the most romantic contract husband they've ever met.

Sophia bites back a smile, taking the flowers.

SOPHIA
You know this isn't necessary, right?

ALEX
As long as you're my wife, you'll be treated like one.

Sophia pauses, thrown off for half a second. Then—

SOPHIA
(recovering, teasing)
Well, in that case… my dear husband, I have a complaint. This steak? Not as good as yours.

ALEX
I'll cook for you tomorrow. Tonight? You'll survive.

A waiter appears, setting a small cake on the table.

WAITER
Happy one-week anniversary! Make a wish!

Alex wheels closer, their shoulders brushing as they lean in. Then, together, they blow out the candle. Their eyes meet.

Then-Alex kisses her. No hesitation.

CUT TO BLACK.

EPISODE 13

23 **EXT. ROOFTOP - NIGHT** 23

A panoramic city skyline. Lights shimmer against the dark sky. Alex sits in his wheelchair. Sophia stands beside him, gazing out.

SOPHIA
(soft, surprised)
I never realized how beautiful the city looks from here.

ALEX
(watching her, voice low)
Me neither.

Sophia glances at him.

SOPHIA
You know… you're going to make a great husband someday.

ALEX
I already am.

Sophia laughs lightly, but then—she steps back—loses her balance. Alex catches her effortlessly. Their faces hover close, breath mingling.

SOPHIA
(soft, breathless)
…Thanks.

Alex steadies her, then lifts her legs onto his lap.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
What are you—

Alex removes her heel, fingers brushing against her ankle.

ALEX
Those shoes are torture. Don't wear them again.

He reaches behind him, pulling out a pair of sneakers.

ALEX (CONT'D)
In front of me, you can be comfortable. Always.

Alex slips the sneaker onto her foot. It fits perfectly. Sophia stares at him.

SOPHIA
You knew my size?

ALEX (LOW, STEADY)
I know everything about you.

Then—fireworks explode overhead. Sophia gasps, her face lighting up as colors dance across the sky.

SOPHIA
Alex… this is beautiful.

ALEX
(watching her, voice even softer)
It's for you.

Sophia turns to him. Without thinking, she leans in—kisses him.

EPISODE 14

24 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 24

Soft lighting. Sophia and Alex kiss—slow, lingering. Fingers tangled, breath mingling.

Alex pulls off his shirt, muscles flexing under her touch. Sophia's hands roam, tracing the heat of his skin. Then—she shifts, gently pushing him back, straddling him.

ALEX
(low, teasing)
You like being on top?

Sophia smirks, fingers gliding over his chest.

SOPHIA
(soft, playful)
Just thought I'd give you a break.
You are in a wheelchair, after all.

Alex chuckles, gaze steady on hers.

ALEX
I don't need one.

Sophia leans in, lips brushing his as the kiss deepens.

25 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - NIGHT - LATER** 25

Moonlight filters through the curtains. Alex and Sophia lie close, bodies warm against the cool sheets.

Sophia shifts, half-asleep. Her arm drapes over him, pulling him in. Her fingers trace the slope of his neck… his chest… drifting lower.

Then—her hand brushes against his thigh. A small twitch.

Sophia frowns, still hazy with sleep.

SOPHIA
(murmuring)
Alex… did your leg just… move?

Alex's eyes open. He doesn't move.

EPISODE 15

26 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - MORNING** 26

Soft morning light filters in. Sophia stirs, stretching lazily—until she feels the solid warmth beside her. Her eyes snap open. Alex. She sucks in a breath, peeking under the sheets.

SOPHIA
Oh God… I actually slept with Alex?

Her gaze lingers—broad shoulders, defined chest, down to—

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Damn... eight-pack abs? That's… unfair.

FLASHBACK

Last night. Dim light. Breathless kisses. Hands tangled.

END OF FLASHBACK

Sophia freezes. Her eyes drift lower—to his legs.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
He looks just like that guy.... No. Stop. That's impossible.

But—she hesitates, then barely brushes his thigh.

SOPHIA
(murmuring, hesitant)
Alex… did your leg moved last ni—

Alex moves, smoothly rolling on top of her. Sophia lets out a soft gasp, pinned beneath him.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Uh… morning?

AEARON
Good morning. Didn't know my wife was so...affectionate.

Sophia flushes, pushing at his chest.

SOPHIA
I was not! I was just… uh, stretching.

ALEX
Stretching, huh? Need a little sexy morning workout? I'm happy to help.

SOPHIA
Nope! I'm good. More than good.

Alex adjusts slightly, pressing closer.

ALEX
Then stay still, sweetheart. Or I might take that as an invitation.

Sophia goes completely still. Their eyes lock. The heat lingers—RING! Her phone buzzes. She grabs it, exhaling. On the screen—

AMBER (TEXT)
Come to the office. I've got a secret that'll blow your mind.

EPISODE 16

27 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - DAY** 27

Sophia flips through a file at her desk. Across from her, Amber leans in, smirking.

AMBER
Sophia, sweetie… Has your perfect husband ever told you about his first love?
(leaning in, enjoying herself)
He may have married you, but trust me—his heart's always belonged to someone else.

SOPHIA
(deadpan, sharp)
He's my husband. Whether he loves me or not, he definitely doesn't love you.

Amber stiffens, her smirk faltering.

AMBER
You really are delusional!

Sophia stands, straightening her blazer, calm as ever.

SOPHIA
Amber, why don't you mind your own business and start updating your résumé. Cuz first thing I'm doing as CEO-is firing dead weight like you.

Amber's face twists in fury. She snatches a pen holder off the desk and hurls it—

Sophia sidesteps without missing a beat. The holder crashes against the wall.

AMBER
You bitch!

Sophia turns, blow kisses to Amber with a wink before striding out.

28 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS** 28

Sophia walks, phone in hand. Her smirk fades slightly.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
So, Alex does have a first love…
Whatever. Priorities.

She types a message, then hits send.

SOPHIA (TEXT)
Dinner's off. Meeting Everest's rep
at Captain's Bar. Wish me luck.

29 **INT. LAWRENCE MANSION - NIGHT** 29

Amber storms into the lavish living room, Sally lounging with a glass of wine. Amber grabs her mother's wrist, seething.

AMBER
Mom, we can't let Sophia close this
Everest deal. If she does, we're
screwed!

Sally swirls her wine, unconcerned.

SALLY
Relax, darling. Everest's rep, Ralph?
He's got a… particular kink. And
Sophia is exactly his type.

Amber pauses, then smirks.

AMBER
Oh, this is getting good.

EPISODE 17

30 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - NIGHT** 30

Alex stands at the window, city lights reflecting in his glassy stare.

WILLIAM
Victor was involved in the car accident. That much we know. But they wiped every piece of surveillance from that road. No proof. No case.

ALEX
I've waited three years. What's a little longer? Once Sophia secures Lawrence Corp, we'll have access to recover the data.

WILLIAM
There's something else. The woman who saved you that night—we might finally have a lead.

Alex finally turns, interest flickering.

ALEX
Find her. Whatever it takes.

His phone buzzes. Alex glances at the screen. A message from Sophia.

SOPHIA (TEXT)
Dinner's off. Meeting Everest's rep at Captain's Bar tonight. Wish me luck.

ALEX
Who's handling the meeting?

William checks his phone—then tenses.

WILLIAM
…Ralph.

Alex sets his coffee down, grabs his coat, and strides out.

ALEX
Get the car. Now!

31 **INT. CAPTAIN'S BAR - NIGHT** 31

Sophia smiles smoothly, clinking glasses with Ralph.

SOPHIA
Here's to a successful partnership, Mr. Ralph.

She takes a sip. Ralph watches her, his gaze lingering.

RALPH
Before we finalize anything, I wanna see how... enthusiastic you are about this deal.

Sophia nods, pulling out a sleek folder.

SOPHIA
Of course. Our latest proposal—

RALPH
Not what I meant. I prefer a more… personal approach. Your scar, is such a turn on for me, Miss Lawrence.

He reaches out, tracing a finger along her scar.

SOPHIA
Don't touch. Me!

Ralph laughs. He shoves her back into the couch.

RALPH
Relax. Let's toast to a real partnership.

He grabs the wine bottle and force Sophia to drink it. Sophia struggles, then grabs the nearest glass and smashes it against Ralph's head.

Ralph stumbles back, dazed. Sophia gasps, scrambling toward the door—

RALPH (CONT'D)
You bitch! You're gonna pay for that—

Then—Sophia crashes into a man with deep blue tie.

Standing. No wheelchair.

SOPHIA
…Alex?

Her vision blurs. She slumps against him, unconscious.

Ralph stumbles out of the booth—until his gaze locks onto Alex.

RALPH
Mr.X…

ALEX
(low, lethal)
Now that you've had your fun… let's talk about mine.

EPISODE 19

32 **INT. CAPTAIN'S BAR- NIGHT** 32

Alex holds Sophia against his chest.

RALPH
Mr.X, I swear! It was her! That ugly bitch tried to steal our company secrets—she attacked me!

Alex kicks Ralph square in the chest. Ralph hits the ground, groaning.

ALEX
That's my wife you're talking about. If she wanted this company, it'd already be hers.

RALPH
(panicked, desperate)
P-Please, Mr. X! I was just following orders! I didn't know!

Alex slowly crouches, his grip locking around Ralph's collar. He pulls him in, voice dangerously low.

ALEX
Whose orders?

RALPH
(stammering)
A-Amber Lawrence…!

ALEX
(to William)
Get the lawyers. Have him confess. Word for word.

William nods, stepping forward.

ALEX (FLAT, FINAL) (CONT'D)
And William… he touched my wife. Whichever hand he used—he won't be needing it anymore.

Ralph lets out a choked noise—But Alex's already walking away, Sophia secure in his arms.

33 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - BEDROOM - NIGHT** 33

Alex lays Sophia gently onto the bed. His fingers brush against her temple, pushing stray hair away.

ALEX
I should've been there sooner.

Sophia stirs, blinking hazily—she grabs his shirt and pulls him down, pressing a drowsy kiss against his lips.

Alex freezes.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Sophia… do you even know who you're kissing?

SOPHIA
(half-conscious)
Alex… no… X?

EPISODE 20

34 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - BEDROOM - MORNING** 34

Sophia stirs awake, groaning as she rubs her temple.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
Last night… Who brought me back?

Alex appears, smoothly pulling her into his arms.

ALEX
Good morning, Mrs. Christopher. How are you feeling?

SOPHIA
(muttering)
Like I got hit by a truck… How did I get home?

ALEX
Sophia… last night, Everest Capital's CEO—X—brought you back.

SOPHIA
So it was X…Alex, do you know him?

ALEX
(shrugging, playing dumb)
No. Why would I?

SOPHIA
I remember… He was tall. Broad shoulders. Looked a lot like you…

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
And—your legs! Are they getting better? That night… I swear I felt them move.

ALEX
(mock hurt, voice low)
Sophia… are you saying that you regret marrying a cripple?
(beat, then sighs dramatically, placing a hand over his chest as if heartbroken)
Sometimes, I wish I could walk again. But alas… life can be so cruel.

Sophia shoves his shoulder.

SOPHIA
You know that's not what I meant!

Alex chuckles, brushing a strand of hair from her face.

ALEX
Relax, sweetheart. Just messing with you.

SOPHIA
(murmuring, distracted)
—I didn't close the deal with Everest Capital. If I can't secure that partnership, I will lose my claim to Lawrence Corp!

Before Alex can respond—her phone rings. Sophia takes the call. Her eyes widen.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(shocked, sitting up)
Wait… what?!

EPISODE 21

35 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - BEDROOM - MORNING** 35

Sophia lowers her phone, eyes wide, disbelief flickering across her face.

SOPHIA
That was Everest Capital… X agreed to sign the contract with me!

Alex calmly reaches into a drawer and pulls out a contract, holding it out.

ALEX
You mean… this one? You brought it back last night.

Sophia slowly takes the contract, staring at it, confused.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
But...why? Why would X agree to work with me?

Alex gently tugs the contract back, sighing dramatically.

ALEX
I wish I could help you like X did… but, well… my legs…

Sophia doesn't hesitate, gripping his hands.

SOPHIA
Doesn't matter. Once I take back Lawrence Corp, I can protect you.

Alex tilts his head, eyes softening.

ALEX
Sophia… I'll always be by your side. Whatever you need.

Sophia catches her reflection in the mirror. Her hands lift—she peels off the fake scar.

SOPHIA
Watch me. I'm taking back everything.

36 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - BOARDROOM - DAY** 36

The shareholders check their watches, irritated.

BOARD MEMBER #1
She's late. No way she closed the deal.

AMBER
Told you—Everest Capital doesn't work with nobodies.

Mr. Lawrence clears his throat, adjusting his tie.

MR. LAWRENCE
Given the circumstances, I'll be resuming my position as CEO—

The doors swing open. Sophia steps in. No scar. Alex besides her, composed, unreadable.

Sophia smirks, sweeping her eyes across the stunned room.

SOPHIA
Who said I failed?

EPISODE 22

37 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - BOARDROOM - DAY** 37

Sophia stands at the head of the table, holding up a signed contract.

SOPHIA
Per our agreement, I secured the Everest Capital deal. That means I run Lawrence Corp now.

Amber stares, eyes wide.

AMBER
Your scar—where is it?!

Sophia smirks, casually pulling a strip of fake skin from her pocket and tossing it onto the table.

SOPHIA
You mean this?

AMBER
No… no, this isn't possible. You weren't even supposed to come back!

SOPHIA
(soft, lethal)
You mean after your little setup? Sending Ralph after me? That's cute. Really.

MR. LAWRENCE
(gritted teeth)
Enough! Stop this nonsense!

Alex leans forward, sliding a document across the table.

ALEX
Official statement from Everest's CEO—confirming Amber Lawrence instructed Ralph to harass his business partner, Sophia Lawrence.

The board members murmur. Amber pales.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Everest Capital has entered a permanent partnership with Lawrence Corp—under Sophia's leadership. And Mr. David Lawrence and Amber Lawrence- you're blacklisted.

SOPHIA
You two are both officially removed from Lawrence Corp. Effective immediately!

EPISODE 23

38 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - BOARDROOM - DAY** 38

Security drags Amber and Mr. Lawrence toward the exit. Amber thrashes, screeching.

AMBER
You bitch! You think this is over?!

MR. LAWRENCE
Sophia, you ungrateful skank—I'm your father! You can't do this to me!

SOPHIA
Watch me.

The doors slam shut behind them.

39 **EXT. LAWRENCE CORP - OFFICE ENTRANCE - DAY** 39

Security tosses Amber's belongings onto the pavement. A crowd watches.

Amber shoves papers into her purse, but then—she smirks.

AMBER
You think you've won? The Christophers treat your husband like a joke. He's on borrowed time after that accident!

SOPHIA (V.O.)
What…?

Amber steps closer, dropping her voice to a whisper.

AMBER
You really think he married you for love? Honey, you were just convenient.

A hand clamps onto Amber's wrist— tight.

ALEX
What the hell are you saying to my wife?

He shoves her backward—Amber stumbles, collapsing onto her own luggage.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Get the fuck out! Unless you really want to test my patience.

Amber snaps. Eyes wild, she grabs a pair of scissors from a fallen box and lunges—

AMBER
You should've died with your mother, you wretched—

Alex shoves Sophia aside, gripping the blade bare-handed. Blood drips down his wrist.

SOPHIA
Alex!

EPISODE 24

40 **INT. LUXURY JEWELRY STORE - DAY** 40

Sophia steps inside, her gaze sweeping over the gleaming displays. Her brow furrows.

SOPHIA
Everest Capital's jewelry store? What are we doing here?

Alex, effortlessly composed despite his bandaged hand, wheels forward, scanning the pieces.

ALEX
Our wedding was rushed. Figured it's time my wife got what she deserves.

A sales associate lays out a selection of jewelry. Alex picks a necklace—a pigeon-blood ruby surrounded by diamonds.

SALES ASSOCIATE
(grinning)
Ah, an exquisite choice. This piece was designed exclusively by…Mr.X himself.

Sophia's head snaps up.

SOPHIA
X?

Alex's gaze darkens—just a flicker. The sales associate swallows hard, scrambling to cover.

SALES ASSOCIATE
(forced chuckle)
Uh—I mean… Mr.Christopher! Silly me! Slip of the tongue!

Suspicion flickering in Sophia's eyes. Alex lifts the necklace, put it around Sophia's neck.

ALEX
This is called Heart of Courage. It suits you.

Sophia fingers the gem.

SOPHIA
The cut, the clarity… this ruby's beyond rare. Alex, this must've cost—

ALEX
(cutting her off)
I don't care. You deserve the best.

SOPHIA
(testing the waters)
Alex… I heard about your first lo—

Alex's phone rings. His expression sharpens instantly. He picks up.

ALEX
What?! You found her?

EPISODE 25

41 **INT. LUXURY JEWELRY BOUTIQUE - DAY** 41

Sophia stands before a mirror, the ruby necklace draped around her neck.

SALES ASSOCIATE
This isn't just a necklace, Mrs. Christopher. It's a symbol of eternal love.

Sophia runs her fingers over the gemstone.

SOPHIA
He must've chosen this a long time ago…

SALES ASSOCIATE
Oh, absolutely. Mr. Christopher placed the order five years ago. He said it was meant for his future wife.

Her fingers tighten around the ruby.

SOPHIA (O.S.)
Five years ago… this wasn't meant for me. It was for her—his first love.

CUT TO:

42 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - ALEX'S OFFICE - DAY** 42

Alex stands at his desk, tense. William strides in, a file in hand.

WILLIAM
(urgent)
We found her. The woman who saved your life that night.

Alex snatches the file, flipping it open. His breath stills. A photograph-Sophia.

43 **FLASHBACK - EXT. ROADSIDE - FIVE YEARS AGO - NIGHT** 43

Twisted metal. Smoke. Blood. Alex, barely conscious. A motorcycle screeches to a stop. A figure rushes toward him—Sophia. She kneels, pressing hands against his bleeding wound.

SOPHIA
Hey! Stay with me!

Then—her lips press against his. CPR.

A cough. A sharp inhale. Alex's eyes snap open, locking onto hers.

BACK TO PRESENT

43A Alex grips the photo tighter. 43A

ALEX
Sophia… it was you.

EPISODE 26

44 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - DAY** 44

Sophia stands in front of the mirror, fingers grazing the ruby necklace. After a beat, she unclasps it and turns to Alex, placing it in his palm.

SOPHIA
Alex.... I can't keep this.

ALEX
Why not?

SOPHIA
This necklace was meant for your first love, wasn't it?

ALEX
It was. But now… it belongs to you.

Sophia exhales, controlled.

SOPHIA
Alex, our marriage was just a contract.
(MORE)

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Now that I have Lawrence Corp back… I'll fulfill my end. I'll start making arrangements tomorrow.

Alex lets out a short, dry chuckle.

ALEX (MOCK-OFFENDED)
Sounds like you're eager to get rid of me.

Sophia steps in, slow and deliberate, fingers brushing his jaw.

SOPHIA
One day, you'll go find your first love. I'd rather not be in the way.

Alex studies her—then lifts his bandaged hands, sighing dramatically.

ALEX
(smirking, playful)
Sophia, you almost sound jealous. But… since you're still my wife, shouldn't a good wife help her injured husband bathe?

45 **INT. ALEX'S BATHROOM - DAY** 45

Alex steps inside, already shirtless. His sculpted chest and abs catch the light as he leans against the counter, watching her.

ALEX
(low, teasing)
Well? My dear wife-like what you see?

EPISODE 27

46 **INT. ALEX'S BATHROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 46

Water drips down Alex's sculpted torso as Sophia runs a washcloth over his abs—her fingers hesitating.

SOPHIA
Nice abs… Guess being a "cripple" didn't stop you from keeping in shape.

Alex smirks. He covers her hand with his, guiding it lower—to his belt.

ALEX
Careful, sweetheart. You're responsible for a poor, helpless man now.

SOPHIA
(mock sympathy)
So tragic. Guess I'll just have to take control. Again.

The belt comes undone. Alex pulls her into his lap, their lips crashing together in a feverish kiss.

The phone rings.

Alex blindly reaching for it. Without looking, he flings it onto the counter. They move back in, lips brushing—

Phone rings again. Alex exhales sharply, irritated, then snatches it up and ends the call with a single tap.

ALEX
(frustrated, breathless)
Sophia. Go. Before I forget I'm supposed to behave.

Sophia exhales a small laugh. She heads for the door—then pauses, turning.

SOPHIA
Oh, one last thing—your towel's on the top shelf. Need help?

Alex meets her gaze through the steam. For a split second—he's standing. The second their eyes lock, he sits back into the wheelchair.

ALEX
I'll manage.

Sophia watches him a beat longer before closing the door behind her.

SOPHIA (O.S.)
(suspicious)
Wait… did he just stand? No. Impossible. Unless… he's hiding something. Guess I'll just have to drop by his office tomorrow. Unannounced.

EPISODE 28

47 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP - ALEX'S OFFICE - DAY** 47

The small office is dimly lit, outdated. Alex lounges in his chair, flipping through a book. The door slams open—William rushes in.

WILLIAM
Mr.X—

ALEX
At Christopher Group, I'm just Alex, the warehouse guy.

William tosses the folder onto the desk. Alex finally looks—Victor's face is plastered across the page.

WILLIAM
Lawrence Corp's tech team recovered the deleted footage. We finally have him—Victor was the one caused the accident!

ALEX
Make copies. Send them to Everest Capital's legal team.

He closes the folder with finality, his gaze sharp as a blade.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Let's end this.

48 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP - LOBBY - DAY** 48

Sophia strides in, with a lunchbox. She approaches the front desk.

SOPHIA (O.S.)
If Alex's hiding something, he might slip up at work. Lucky for me—I have the perfect excuse.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Hi, I'm Sophia Christopher—Alex's wife. Just dropping off lunch.

RECEPTIONIST
I'm sorry, ma'am. Mr. Christopher isn't taking unscheduled visits.

SOPHIA
I'm not here for a business meeting. Just lunch.

RECEPTIONIST
I'm afraid we have strict policies. You'll need an appointment.

Sophia exhales, suppressing irritation. She turns—slams straight into a firm chest. A deep blue tie catches her eye.

FLASHBACK - EPISODE 18

Sophia, cornered, colliding into a man in a deep blue tie.

END OF FLASHBACK

SOPHIA
(breath hitching)
…You!

EPISODE 29

49 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP - LOBBY - DAY** 49

Victor looms closer, his smirk slow, calculating.

VICTOR
So... You're my sister-in-law, huh?

SOPHIA
You're... Victor Christopher?

Her gaze flicks over him—the height, the tie, the build.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
The tie…the height…even his face looks like the man at the lounge that night! Could Victor be X?

Victor watches her. Then—he leans in, brushing her hair aside.

VICTOR
Such a shame. A woman like you, wasted on a man who can't even stand on his own.

Sophia slaps his hand away.

SOPHIA
Hey! Keep your hands to yourself.

VICTOR
Wow. Fiery.

SOPHIA
(testing)
Victor... have you been to the Captain's bar lately?

VICTOR
Well... you tell me.

SOPHIA
Are you... X? If you really saved me, fine—I owe you. But don't think for a second that gives you the right to disrespect Alex.

VICTOR
(teasing)
Owe me? Now that is an interesting thought. Maybe we can discuss repayment…

His leans in—just as if to kiss her.

ALEX (O.S)
Touch her, and you lose that fucking hand.

Alex sits in his wheelchair, gaze razor-sharp.

EPISODE 30

50 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP - LOBBY - DAY** 50

Sophia rushes to Alex's side—his grip on her hand firm, possessive.

ALEX
Touch my wife again, and you'll regret it.

VICTOR
Relax, my dear brother. No need to get worked up. I was just being friendly.

He steps closer, dropping his voice, eyes glinting.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Or are you just worried about the Christopher Group Gala tonight? What's wrong—scared to show up in front of the whole family and remind everyone you're nothing but a cripple?

ALEX
We'll be there.

Victor chuckles, stepping back.

VICTOR
I look forward to seeing you, Sophia.

51 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - BEDROOM - DAY** 51

Sophia stands in front of a mirror. Alex moves behind her, putting a necklace around her neck.

SOPHIA
Victor… he's your brother, isn't he? He kinda reminds me of... X.

ALEX
Victor? X? Please. He's nothing but my father's bastard child—and the reason I'm in this wheelchair.

SOPHIA
(stunned)
He's the one who—?

ALEX
(nods)
I've been hunting for proof. Soon, I'll have everything I need to end this.

Sophia turns to face him, searching his gaze.

SOPHIA
Alex… do you hate him?

ALEX
I did. Until you came along… and reminded me there's more to life than revenge.

Sophia's fingers lace through his—tight, deliberate.

SOPHIA
I'll stay by your side. No matter what comes next.

CLOSE UP Their hands remain locked—tight, unbreakable.

SOPHIA (O.S.) (CONT'D)
If only the past didn't exist. No first love, no what-ifs… just us.
(MORE)

SOPHIA (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Just him and me—as husband and wife.

EPISODE 31

52 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - BANQUET HALL - NIGHT** 52

Alex and Sophia step inside, their presence turning heads. Mr.Christoper approaches, wine in hand, eyes scanning Sophia with interest.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
So, you're Sophia. As striking as I expected. You know, Alex's kept his distance since the accident—if I hadn't insisted on meeting you, he wouldn't have shown up at all.

ALEX
Father, you know my health makes outings… inconvenient.

MR.CHRISTOPHER
Alex, tonight is a celebration. Stop dragging old wounds into it.

A flicker of tension. Sophia steps in smoothly, raising her glass.

SOPHIA
It's an honor to finally meet you, sir.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Come, let's talk. Just the two of us.

53 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - PRIVATE LOUNGE - NIGHT** 53

Sophia follows Mr.Christopher into a private lounge. He pours himself a drink, then gestures to her necklace.

MR.CHRISTOPHER
That necklace… Alex must truly care about you to give you that.

Sophia fingers the pendant, brow furrowing.

MR.CHRISTOPHER (CONT'D)
It was his mother's. One of the few things she left behind.

SOPHIA
Alex's mother? I heard she passed away early…

MR.CHRISTOPHER
Yes. Both his and Victor's mothers are gone. I only hope my sons can look after each other.

SOPHIA
Alex said… Victor was responsible for his accident.

MR.CHRISTOPHER
Victor? Hurt his own brother? That's absurd.

SOPHIA
Powerful families don't stay powerful without a little… treachery.

A knock interrupts them. The door opens—Victor leans in, sharp suit, sharper smirk.

VICTOR
Father, Nevian's chairman is expecting you.

MR.CHRISTOPHER
Business calls. Sophia, we'll continue this another time.

He exits. Sophia turns to leave—but Victor moves fast, cutting her off.

VICTOR
Sophia-wait. I owe you an apology.

SOPHIA
For what?

Before she can react—his hand strikes her neck. Her vision blurs.

54 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - GUEST ROOM - NIGHT** 54

Sophia lies unconscious on an opulent bed. Victor stands over her, gaze trailing her face as he tucks a loose strand of hair behind her ear.

VICTOR
Can't wait to see Alex's face when he realizes he's too late.

EPISODE 32

55 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - GUEST ROOM - NIGHT** 55

Sophia lies still, her bare shoulders peeking from beneath the sheets. Victor, lounging beside her, lifts his phone and snaps a selfie. A slow smirk spreads across his face as he hits send.

VICTOR (V.O.)
Brother, your wife was so insatiable last night. I could barely keep up.

Sophia's phone buzzes—Alex is calling. Victor picks it up, eyes glinting with amusement.

55A ALEX (O.S) 55A
Victor, what the hell did you do to her?

55B VICTOR 55B
Sophia? Oh, we had a very intimate evening. I have to say....I enjoyed every bit of it.

55C ALEX (O.S) 55C
I swear to God Victor—

55D 3VICTOR 55D
Shhh… you don't wanna wake her, do you? She's right here, curled up in my bed… nothing on but my sheets.

He ends the call.

56 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - GUEST ROOM - MORNING** 56

Sophia stirs. Her eyes dart around—her breath catches. She's in bed. Next to Victor. And she's not wearing anything. She yanks the sheets up.

SOPHIA
Victor?! What the hell—? We… we didn't—

VICTOR
Morning, sweetheart. You were all over me last night. Kept begging me to—

SOPHIA
Liar! I'd never—

Victor unlocks his phone, turning the screen toward her.

VICTOR
Then how do you explain this?

A photo. Sophia—bare-shouldered, eyes closed—wrapped in Victor's arms.

EPISODE 33

57 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - GUEST ROOM - MORNING** 57

Sophia's eyes blazing as she lunges at Victor, kicking him hard.

SOPHIA
You fucking asshole! I'm gonna kill you!

Victor dodges, then lands a sharp slap, knocking her back onto the bed.

VICTOR
Tsk. Feisty. You're much prettier when you're quiet.

Suddenly—The door slams open. William grips Victor's hair, ripping him off the bed and slammed onto the floor.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Who the hell are you—?! Let me go!

A polished shoe steps into frame. The wheelchair rolls forward. Slowly, Victor lifts his head—locking eyes with Alex's cold gaze.

ALEX
I warned you, Victor. You lay a finger on her… and you're dead.

Victor spits blood, smirks, and pulls out his phone, tilting the screen toward Alex.

VICTOR
Relax, brother. No need to get violent. After all… I have these.

Alex's eyes flick to the screen—explicit photos of Sophia in bed.

ALEX
You son of a—

VICTOR
Careful. One wrong move, and these little gems go viral.

ALEX
(to William)
Get the damn phone.

William steps forward, but Victor backs up.

VICTOR
Oh, please. You think I wouldn't have backups?

ALEX
What do you want?

VICTOR
Simple. Step down. Announce your resignation as Everest Capital's CEO. Hand everything over to me.

He twirls the phone between his fingers, watching Alex's expression darken.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Or… we let the world see exactly what your wife was up to last night.

EPISODE 34

58 **INT. CHRISTOPHER ESTATE - GUEST ROOM - MORNING** 58

Alex takes the contract from Victor, eyes cold, unwavering. Without hesitation, he signs his name.

VICTOR
(laughing)
And just like that, Everest Capital is mine! Damn, brother. Trading a billion-dollar empire for a woman? That's real devotion. Or real stupidity.

ALEX
Delete the photos. You'll have my resignation in three months.

VICTOR
Three months?

ALEX
Take it. Or I'll make sure we both burn.

A tense beat. Then—Victor smirks, pocketing the contract.

VICTOR
Fine. Not like those crippled legs of yours are going anywhere in three months.

59 **INT. ALEX'S STUDY - NIGHT** 59

Alex sits, reading. The door creaks open—Sophia steps inside, hesitant.

SOPHIA
Alex… after everything with Victor, I think… maybe we should end this.

ALEX
Sophia, none of this was your fault.

SOPHIA
(forcing a small smile)
You deserve real happiness. A fresh start. Maybe even… with the woman you've always loved. Don't worry—I'll still hold up my end of the deal.

Alex exhales, shutting his book.

ALEX
Silly… do you remember the stormy night five years ago on Houston Road? The car crash?

59A **FLASHBACK - EXT. ROADSIDE - FIVE YEARS AGO - NIGHT** 59A

Sophia kneeling beside a wrecked car and an unconscious man, dialing 911. Sirens wailing in the distance.

BACK TO PRESENT

59B Her breath stutters. 59B

SOPHIA
It was you…

Alex takes her hand and presses it against his chest, gaze burning into hers.

ALEX
(soft, absolute)
You were never second. Never a replacement. My first love… my savior. It's always been you, Sophia.

EPISODE 35

60 **INT. ALEX'S STUDY - NIGHT** 60

Sophia hesitates.

SOPHIA
But—

Alex presses a finger to her lips. He kisses her, deep and possessive.

61 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 61

Moonlight filters through the curtains. Alex and Sophia move together, lost in the heat of the moment. His hands roam her body, slow, deliberate.

Sophia meets his gaze—then, with a teasing smirk, pushes him back and straddles him.

ALEX
(low, teasing)
Taking charge again, Mrs. Christopher?

Sophia leans down, lips brushing his. Their mouths crash together—hungry, breathless.

62 **INT. ALEX'S STUDY - NIGHT** 62

Subtitle: TWO MONTHS LATER

Alex stands by the window, phone to his ear.

ALEX
Stick to the plan. When I 'resign,' nothing changes. I still own this game.

He hangs up, eyes narrowing.

63 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 63

A packed room. Executives murmur as the news plays.

63A NEWS ANCHOR (V.O.) 63A
Breaking—X, the mysterious CEO of Everest Capital, has officially resigned. The reason remains unclear.

63B Executives whisper, tension thick. 63B

EXECUTIVE #1
This is a disaster!

EXECUTIVE #2
We're about to close the Clent deal—who's running the show now?

The doors swing open. Victor strolls in, exuding arrogance.

VICTOR
Gentlemen, let's not panic. Everest Capital is in excellent hands—mine.

A slow, deliberate smirk.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
I, Victor Christopher, will be your new CEO. And trust me, this company's future- It just got a hell of a lot brighter.

WILLIAM (O.S.)
Hold on to that thought.

EPISODE 36

64 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 64

The doors slam open—William strides in, a knowing smirk on his face, a stack of documents in hand.

WILLIAM
Hate to interrupt your little coronation, but there's been a… change in management.

VICTOR
Who the hell are you? This is an executive meeting. Not a place for—

William smirks, flipping through the documents before laying them out for the board members.

WILLIAM
Before stepping down, Mr.X transferred 70% of his shares to me. And with my existing 30%—well, do the math.

Victor's smirk vanishes.

WILLIAM (CONT'D)
That's right. I own this company now.

Gasps ripple through the boardroom. Victor lunges for the papers, scanning them in disbelief.

VICTOR
This—this is a joke!

The doors open again—security enters.

WILLIAM
And as my first order of business… Gentlemen, please escort "CEO" Victor out.

VICTOR
You can't do this! I'M THE CEO!

Victor struggles as the guards drag him toward the exit.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
I swear, I'll make you pay for this!

The doors slam shut behind him.

65 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - MORNING** 65

Alex watches the live footage on his tablet—Victor, red-faced, being thrown out like trash. He smiles.

Sophia walks in, setting down a plate of breakfast.

SOPHIA
You've been home a lot lately. Is...everything okay at the company?

EPISODE 37

66 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - KITCHEN - DAY** 66

Sophia sets a plate down. Alex wheels over, watching her with a smirk.

ALEX
What's with that look? Getting tired of having me around?

SOPHIA
Alex… did someone piss you off at the office? Or is Victor playing dirty again?

ALEX
Wow. Can't a man just want to spend time with his wife? The real question is—will the mighty CEO of Lawrence Group take care of me?

SOPHIA
Alex, running the company is tough, but keeping my husband fed? Please. That's light work.

ALEX
(leaning in, teasing)
Careful, I might sticking around for life, Mrs.CEO.

SOPHIA
I could use a full-time househusband.

They exchange a look. Sophia grabs a piece of toast, takes a bite—then freezes. Alex bites his own and immediately winces.

ALEX
(choking)
Sophia… what did you do to this?

SOPHIA
Oh my god—I swapped the salt and sugar!

Alex sighs, setting his fork down.

ALEX
Three minutes. Don't move.

Alex rolls into the kitchen. Moments later, he returns with two perfectly cooked omelets.

SOPHIA
Damn. Alex, you sure you don't wanna quit business and just cook for me full-time?

They share a smile—warm, easy. Then—door bell rings. William strolls in, flopping onto the couch.

WILLIAM
Good news! Guess who just pitched Victor's biggest client? He's so screwed.

Alex leans back, gaze sharpening.

ALEX
Perfect. Let's make sure he never recovers.

EPISODE 38

67 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - VICTOR'S OFFICE - DAY** 67

Victor leans back, smug, feet propped up on his desk, phone in hand.

VICTOR
(into phone)
Trust me, whether it's Christopher Group or Everest Capital, as long as I'm running things, our deal is locked in.

The door swings open. William strides in, all confidence, tapping his earpiece like it's just another Tuesday.

WILLIAM
Victor. Got some exciting news for you.

VICTOR
(skeptical)
Unless it's you resigning, I doubt I care.

William smirks, then—

INTERCUT WITH

68 **INT. ALEX'S HOME - DAY** 68

Alex, lounging in his chair, fingers tapping against his whiskey glass, eyes locked on a tablet.

ALEX
Our biggest investor Mr.Frank just decided to negotiate directly with our board.

BACK TO

69 **INT. VICTOR'S OFFICE - DAY** 69

WILLIAM
Our biggest investor Mr.Frank just decided to negotiate directly with our board.

WILLIAM (CONT'D)
(grinning)
Which means… you're officially off the hook! No stress, no responsibility- exciting, huh?

Victor slams his phone onto the desk, standing abruptly.

VICTOR
You son of a—

William pats his shoulder like he's comforting a child.

WILLIAM
Hey, business is cutthroat. Hang in there, buddy.

CUT TO

70 **EXT. EVEREST CAPITAL - DAY** 70

William exits, adjusting his cufflinks. He presses his earpiece.

WILLIAM
Alex, that was almost too easy.

Alex's chuckle hums through the line.

ALEX (O.S.)
Let him squirm a little longer.

71 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP- SOPHIA'S OFFICE - DAY** 71

Sophia absently chews a sandwich, expression dead inside.

SECRETARY
(businesslike)
Boss, your next meeting starts in thirty minutes. I'll prepare the materials now.

The secretary exits. The moment the door shuts—Sophia groans, forehead thunking onto her desk.

SOPHIA
(muffled)
Corporate life is killing me… slowly… painfully…

A mouthwatering aroma drifts in. Sophia lifts her head—on the desk, a neatly packed meal. Across from her, Alex sits in his wheelchair, smirking.

ALEX
A proper househusband would never let his hardworking boss go hungry.

Sophia gasps in delight, snatching up the utensils like a starved prisoner.

SOPHIA
(giddy)
I swear, I'd marry you all over again just for this!

Alex watches her eat, amusement in his gaze. Then, he notices—her shoelace is undone. Without a word, he lifts her leg, resting it on his knee. Gently, he ties her laces, fingers moving with ease.

Sophia stills, watching him. Something warm, something dangerously close to love flickers in her eyes.

EPISODE 40

72 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 72

Sophia commands the room, laser-focused, gesturing at the screen as execs take notes.

SOPHIA
Our deal with Everest Capital is a game changer. If we execute—

Execs nod in agreement.

EXECUTIVE #1
(impressed)
No doubt. Under Sophia, our profits have skyrocketed.

EXECUTIVE #2
Yeah, but when was the last time she slept? Look at her—she's running on fumes!

SOPHIA
(scoffs)
Oh please. I'm not some fragile damsel—I'm a warrior in heels.

Suddenly, her vision blurs. The laser pointer slips from her hand—then, her knees buckle.

EXECUTIVE #1
(panic)
Sophia?! Are you alright?! Somebody call the ambulance!

Utter chaos. Shouting. Phones dialing for an ambulance.

73 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - LATER** 73

Sophia blinks awake to the blinding white of a hospital room. A doctor stands beside her, flipping through a chart.

DOCTOR
Good news—you're not dying. Just exhausted. But—there's something else.

Sophia blinks groggily.

SOPHIA
What…?

DOCTOR
(grinning)
You're three months pregnant. Congratulations.

Beat. Her breath hitches.

SOPHIA
(flat)
I'm sorry—what?

DOCTOR
You're pregnant!

Sophia stares, mind reeling.

SOPHIA
This… this can't be happening!

Her fingers tighten on the blanket, heart pounding as realization hits.

EPISODE 41

74 **INT. HOSPITAL - OB/GYN OFFICE - DAY** 74

Sophia sits across from the doctor, arms crossed, tension in her every muscle.

DOCTOR
We've triple-checked the results.
There's no mistake—you ARE pregnant.

FLASH CUTS

— Sophia tangled in sheets with Victor, a blur of limbs.

— Sophia gasping as Alex pulls her closer, his hands firm on her waist.

BACK TO THE PRESENT

Sophia stiffens, forcing a breath.

SOPHIA
This… this wasn't supposed to happen.

DOCTOR
That's your choice, but… Sophia, your medical history suggests complications. If you terminate, there's a high chance you may never conceive again.

Sophia's fingers tighten around the exam table, her knuckles white.

SOPHIA
(conflicted)
I...I need time to digest this.

75 **INT. HOSPITAL HALLWAY - DAY** 75

Sophia walks in a daze. She brushes past a woman in oversized sunglasses and a scarf—doesn't even glance up.

It's Amber.

THUD—Sophia's medical report slips from her grasp. The paper lands face-up, bold letters reading: "OB/GYN."

SOPHIA
(muttered)
Excuse me.

She hastily snatches it up and rushes off.

Amber pulls off her sunglasses, watching Sophia disappear before smoothly turning on her heel—heading straight for the OB/GYN office.

76 **INT. OB/GYN RECEPTION - MOMENTS LATER** 76

Amber steps up to the front desk, all sugar and silk.

AMBER
Hi, I'm Amber Lawrence—Sophia's sister. She's been a little… emotional lately. I just wanted to check on her results.

She tilts her head, voice dripping with false concern.

AMBER (CONT'D)
Family should look out for each other, am I right?

EPISODE 42

77 **INT. CAFE - DAY** 77

Amber storms in, spotting Victor, who's lounging with his coffee, smug as ever.

AMBER
(hissing)
You told me it was just an act! Then why the hell is Sophia pregnant?!

VICTOR
(scoffs, raising his hands)
Relax. I never touched her. That kid isn't mine.

AMBER
(snarling)
Then who else? Her crippled husband? You expect me to believe that?

VICTOR
(chuckles)
Guess our dear Sophia's not as innocent as she seems. But hey, this could work in our favor... imagine the scandal. A wife caught between two brothers. How do you think Alex will handle that?

They exchange a knowing smirk.

78 **INT. HOSPITAL LOBBY - DAY** 78

Sophia clutches her phone, tension all over her face.

SPLIT SCREEN

79 **INT. ALEX'S STUDY - DAY** 79

Alex, on the other end of the call, listens, expression unreadable.

SOPHIA
(low, hesitant)
Alex… I'm pregnant.

ALEX
(soft, stunned joy)
Wait—seriously?! That's incredible!

SOPHIA
No. It's not. Because I don't know… if it's yours.

Silence. Alex's jaw tightens.

ALEX
You think it could be Victor's?

SOPHIA
(whispers)
I do… and I can't keep it. I won't.

Alex exhales, gripping the armrest of his wheelchair.

ALEX
(firm)
Sophia. Listen to me. That child is yours. And you… you are mine. Stay there. I'm coming.

Sophia swallows hard, staring at her phone, her fingers gripping it tight.

EPISODE 43

80 **INT. HOSPITAL LOBBY - DAY** 80

Alex wheels through the hospital, scanning the crowd. Outside, a sleek black car idles by the curb. The passenger window rolls down, revealing Sophia in the front seat.

ALEX
Sophia! What the hell are you doing?

Victor leans into view, smirking as he lazily waves.

VICTOR
Relax, brother. We're just taking a little drive. I promise I'll bring her back… eventually.

Alex's fists clench on the armrests of his wheelchair.

ALEX
What the hell did you say to her?

VICTOR
(smirks)
Oh, nothing much. Just helping her see the truth. Let's be real, Alex—you, a cripple, keeping up with her? Come on.

Alex surges forward, ready to knock that smug look off Victor's face, but—

SOPHIA
Alex. Don't.

Alex stills.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
I asked him to meet. I need to handle this with him.

Alex's jaw tightens but he nods. Sophia turns to Victor, cold.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Drive.

Victor grins, revving the engine before peeling away—leaving Alex gripping his wheelchair, eyes burning.

81 **INT. VICTOR'S CAR - DAY** 81

Sophia sits stiffly, gaze locked ahead.

SOPHIA
Victor. That night… nothing actually happened, right?

Victor's fingers tighten around the wheel.

VICTOR
(forces a smile)
Of course it did.

SOPHIA
Then why don't I remember a damn thing?

VICTOR
(smirks, forcing casual)
You passed out. But I remember vividly- you were all over me, sweetheart. Begging for it.

Sophia exhales sharply, then—she grabs a pillow from the backseat and hurls it at him.

SOPHIA
Pull over. Now!

VICTOR
Jesus, woman—

SOPHIA
NOW, VICTOR!

With a screech, the car jerks to a stop.

Sophia throws the door open and steps out, not looking back.

EPISODE 44

82 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - NIGHT** 82

The air is thick with tension. Sophia grips the ultrasound report, her knuckles pale.

SOPHIA
(flat, unwavering)
Alex, I've decided. I'm not keeping this baby.

Alex stiffens, his jaw ticking.

ALEX
Sophia, if you go through with this… you might never be able to have children again.

She exhales, fingers curling tighter around the paper.

SOPHIA
I know how much you hate Victor. If there's even the slightest chance this child is his—how do we live with that? How do you?

Alex moves closer, his hand closing over hers—firm, steady.

ALEX
This isn't about Victor. This child is yours. And that's all I need to know.

She finally meets his gaze—uncertainty flickering in her eyes.

ALEX (CONT'D)
DNA doesn't define family. Love does. And I love you, Sophia. I love everything that comes from you.

A crack forms in her resolve. Slowly, she leans into him, her arms slipping around his waist.

SOPHIA
(whispers)
Alex…thank you.

83 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 83

Alex lounges in bed, flipping through a book. Across the room, Sophia rifles through a drawer, pulling out a calendar.

She flips through the dates, her brows furrowing.

SOPHIA
(muttering)
Victor's reaction today… it was kinda weird.

She stops on a specific date. Her breath hitches.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Alex… something isn't adding up.

EPISODE 45

84 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 84

Alex looks up from the bed, brow furrowed.

ALEX
Everything okay?

Sophia presses a hand over her mouth, staring at the calendar in disbelief.

SOPHIA
The night Victor drugged me… it was barely two months ago. But this baby—it's three months along!

Alex straightens, eyes sharp.

ALEX
You're saying… the baby was conceived before that night?

Their gazes lock—stunned, processing.

SOPHIA
Back then… I hadn't even met you yet. I was supposed to go on a blind date, I stayed at a hotel and there was this guy—
(beat)
It has to be from that night!

Alex exhales, his grip tightening around her waist.

ALEX
It has to be.

SOPHIA
It's not Victor's. Oh my God… it's not his!

She throws her arms around Alex's neck, holding him tight. He pulls her closer, pressing a lingering kiss against her temple. Then—his phone rings.

WILLIAM (O.S)
Alex, Victor's finished. We've taken his suppliers, and the evidence against him has been officially filed in court.

A slow grin spreads across Alex's face. He ends the call, turning back to Sophia.

ALEX
Tomorrow's the Christopher board meeting. Time to end everything.

Sophia reaches into a drawer—pulling out a tape. She places it firmly in his hands.

SOPHIA
This is everything my team uncovered. Play it at the meeting. Make sure Victor never gets back up.

Alex smirks, tucking the tape into his jacket.

ALEX
Oh, don't worry, baby. By tomorrow—he's finished.

EPISODE 46

85 **INT. UPSCALE RESTAURANT - DAY** 85

Amber removes her sunglasses, placing them down. Across from her, Victor leisurely swirls his wine.

AMBER
You should be more careful. Alex's been sniffing around.

VICTOR
Getting nervous? Don't forget, we orchestrated everything together.
(smirks, raising his glass)
So if you play your part well… I'll make you my wife.

AMBER
You better keep your word.

VICTOR
Relax. By tomorrow, the old man will sign everything over to me. Once I'm running Christopher Group, you'll get exactly what you deserve.

They clink glasses.

86 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP- BOARDROOM - DAY** 86

Mr. Christopher sits at the head of the table. His eyes scan the room as he stifles a cough.

Victor, all feigned concern, slides a glass of water toward him.

VICTOR
Father, you shouldn't push yourself like this. The doctor warned you—stress isn't good for your heart.

Christopher Senior dabs his mouth with a napkin, nodding slowly.

CHRISTOPHER SENIOR
You always worry about me, Victor. My good son.

VICTOR
Because I want what's best for you, Father. And for the company.

Mr. Christopher exhales.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
It's time. Time for a new era. I'm officially signing over Christopher Corp… to Victor. Any objections?

BOARD MEMBER #1
A wise choice, sir.

BOARD MEMBER #2
Victor has done nothing but prove his loyalty.

Victor adjusts his cufflinks, barely hiding his smug satisfaction.

VICTOR
(faux humble)
Father, I'll do my best to carry on the family legacy.

A murmur of agreement. Victor relaxes, victory within reach—

Then—FOOTSTEPS.

CLOSE UP polished leather shoes coming to a stop outside the boardroom. A strong hand grips the handle—and pushes the door open.

It's Alex, standing without a wheelchair.

ALEX
I object.

EPISODE 47

87 **INT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP- BOARDROOM - DAY** 87

On-screen, a restored crash video plays—the driver's face unmistakable. It's Victor.

ALEX
There's your "accident." Or should I say, attempted murder.

VICTOR
(hissing)
That footage—impossible. The cameras on that road were—

ALEX
—Sabotaged? Yeah. But lucky for you, Lawrence Group is perfect at data restoration.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
What?! Victor... Tell me this isn't true.

Victor grips the table, desperate, shaking.

VICTOR
I had nothing! I clawed my way up from the slums while he—(points at Alex)—had everything! I just wanted to be seen! To be yours!

WILLIAM
Since we're sharing secrets—here's another big one.

Alex steps forward.

ALEX
After the crash, I played the fool. Faked my injury. I wanted the snake to think he won.
(beat)
In the meantime, I built Everest Capital. That mysterious “X” - it's me.

The boardroom explodes—gasps, whispers, wide eyes.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Alex… you have the patience of a wolf king. You were always meant to lead.
(to Victor)
But you… you chose the wrong path. I’ve given you enough. You are no longer a Christopher.

VICTOR
No. No, no, no—you can’t do this!

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Actions have consequences.

The doors burst open— guards move in. Victor thrashes, screaming.

VICTOR
This isn’t over!

EPISODE 48

88 **EXT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP- DAY** 88

Victor stumbles forward, barely held up by security. A sleek red sports car idles at the curb The window rolls down. Amber, oversized sunglasses, smirks.

AMBER
Well, well. If it isn’t the mighty Victor Christopher.

VICTOR
If you’re here to rub it in, get in line.

AMBER
(chuckles)
You and me? We’re cut from the same cloth. You, the bastard son. Me, the stepdaughter nobody wanted.
(MORE)

AMBER (CONT'D)
(leans in, voice smooth)
So why keep playing their game…
when we can rewrite the rules?

Victor hesitates, then slides into the car. The door slams shut.

89 **EXT. CHRISTOPHER GROUP - ENTRANCE - DAY** 89

Alex steps out. Not a limp in sight. Sophia rushes toward him—then stops.

SOPHIA
(low, stunned)
Alex… your legs. You lied to me?!

ALEX
Sophia, just let me—

SOPHIA
Let you what? Explain how you played me? How you sat there, acting all sweet while I poured my heart out—over a damn LIE?

Alex reaches for her.

ALEX
My feelings for you were never a lie! I just—
(beat)
I had to make sure my plan worked. I couldn't risk—

Sophia steps back, arms crossed.

SOPHIA
And you didn't trust me enough to be part of it? I can't be married to a man who keeps me in the dark.

She exhales, chin lifting, voice steady.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
We're done, Alex. I want a divorce.

Alex freezes. Sophia turns. Walks away.

EPISODE 49

90 **INT. RANDY'S APARTMENT - DAY** 90

Sophia hauls in her suitcases, one after another. RANDY WALDORF (mid-20s, posh, effortlessly spoiled), sprawled on the couch, watches with raised brow.

RANDY
Damn, Viv. You moving in or launching a department store!?

SOPHIA
Come on. You're a trust fund baby with multiple mansions. You telling me you can't spare one room for your bestie?

RANDY
Yeah, well—Daddy put my black card in time-out, so I'm technically broke.
(beat, grinning)
Guess that makes you my sugar mommy now, my CEO bestie.

SOPHIA
Fine. But first—make yourself useful and help me unpack.

Randy groans but drags herself off the couch.

91 **INT. RANDY'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT** 91

Randy is curled up on the couch, glued to the TV. Sophia sits at the vanity, aggressively patting skincare into her face.

RANDY
So… you're really divorcing Alex?

SOPHIA
The man faked an entire disability to guilt-trip me. What am I supposed to do? Applaud the performance?

RANDY
Okay, but—he did kinda do it to take down Victor.

Sophia ignores her. The face-patting intensifies.

Suddenly—the TV cuts to breaking news.

ON SCREEN: Alex Christopher, effortlessly charismatic, stands at the Christopher Corp inheritance ceremony.

NEWS ANCHOR (V.O.)
Alex Christopher has officially assumed leadership of Christopher Group, securing his place as the new CEO—

RANDY
Damn. Your man is really a whole package!
(grinning)
Hey, if you're done with him, I'm happy to—

Before she can finish, Sophia snatches the remote and clicks the TV off. Hard.

EPISODE 50

92 **INT. RANDY'S APARTMENT - MORNING** 92

Music pounds through the apartment. Sophia, jumps through HIIT workout on a yoga mat.

Bedroom door swings open. Randy Waldorf, draped in silk, sleep mask shoved onto her forehead, stares at her, appalled.

RANDY
Sophia. It's 7 AM! Are you possessed?

SOPHIA
(cracking open an energy drink)
Nope. Just making a point. Until he signs the divorce papers, I'm not stepping foot in that house. But life moves on, right?

Her phone buzzes. Another text from Alex—unread.

Randy glances over, then back at Sophia, a knowing smirk creeping in.

RANDY
Still ghosting him? That makes, what, three hundred texts? Damn, that guy is not giving up.

SOPHIA
I don't wanna talk about him.
(checks the time)
I have...
(MORE)

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
exactly twenty-nine minutes until I have to deal with corporate sharks.

Sophia getting dressed for work. Randy tosses an apple her way.

RANDY
At least don't starve yourself!

Sophia catches it with a dramatic sigh, heading out.

93 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 93

Papers everywhere. Sophia, mid-battle with a mountain of contracts, absentmindedly nibbles on a sad, half-eaten sandwich.

SOPHIA
By now, Alex would've dropped off my favorite lunch…

KNOCK. KNOCK. Her head snaps up.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
No way... could it be-

EPISODE 51

94 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - OFFICE - DAY** 94

The door creaks open—her secretary steps in, holding a meal container.

SECRETARY
Boss, the research team's waiting for you.
(beat)
But… someone thought you might skip lunch and brought this.

She places the box down, flipping it open—inside, salmon pasta, plated to perfection.

SOPHIA
Let me guess. Alex.

SECRETARY
You two still… at odds? It's been days.

Sophia exhales sharply, then, with zero hesitation, digs in—finishing in record time.

SOPHIA
(flat, wiping her mouth)
Please. Who has time to fight with a liar? Let's go.

She stands, smoothing her blazer, strides past, leaving the empty container behind.

95 **INT. LAWRENCE CORP - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY** 95

Lights dim. A massive screen flickers on.

TEAM LEAD
This is our biggest breakthrough yet. It's changing how we restore history.

On screen, a reconstructed video plays—the very technology used to restore the crash footage.

TEAM LEAD (CONT'D)
It's the same algorithm we used to assist Everest Capital in restoring the car accident footage.

SOPHIA
Who was your contact at Everest?

TEAM LEAD
Their executive assistant, William.

Something shifts in Sophia's expression. Her fingers tap against the table, brain moving at lightning speed.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
William. Alex's right-hand man. Could Alex...be X?

EPISODE 52

96 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - CEO'S OFFICE - DAY** 96

Sophia strides in. Alex and William turn—but she doesn't even spare Alex a glance, marching straight to William.

SOPHIA
Tell me the truth. Alex is X, isn't it?

William hesitates and looks at Alex for help. Alex nods.

WILLIAM
Yeah. It’s him.

Sophia doesn’t react—just picks up a coffee, takes a slow sip.

WILLIAM (CONT’D)
Look, he had to fake the injury. You think Victor would've stopped if he knew Alex was fine?

SOPHIA
What about lying to me? Was that part of the grand strategy, too?

Alex, behind William, jots another note: "AGREEMENT." William exhales, catching on.

WILLIAM
You think he wasn’t protecting you too? That deal you made with Everest Capital—he made sure it went through. That’s how you secured Lawrence Corp. He risked everything to back you.

Sophia’s fingers tighten around the cup. Another note from Alex: "RALPH."

WILLIAM (CONT’D)
And that night with Ralphs- Alex didn’t even care about blowing his cover. He just ran straight to save you.

A long beat. Then—Sophia finally looks at Alex.

SOPHIA
(to Alex)
I'm going to a charity gala tonight.

Alex arches a brow.

SOPHIA (CONT’D)
Wanna be my plus one? After all... we're still married.

EPISODE 53

97 **INT. UPSCALE CHARITY GALA - NIGHT** 97

The room glows under crystal chandeliers. Sophia, radiant in a sleek gown. Alex. Sharp tux.

A few models hang on his words, but his attention keeps drifting—straight to Sophia. A circle of business elites surrounds Sophia, all eager to toast.

ELITE #1
Ma'am, your leadership is turning heads. A toast—to your continued success.

SOPHIA
Flattering, really. But I'm a disaster with alcohol. Let's not ruin a perfectly good night.

A voice cuts in—FRANK, a powerhouse in the business world, appearing with two drinks.

FRANK
Come on, just one brandy. Consider it an investment—who knows, I might even be generous in our next deal.

Before Sophia can respond, a firm hand sweeps in. Alex plucks the glass from Frank's hand—downs it without breaking eye contact.

ALEX
Appreciate the gesture, Leo. But my wife doesn't drink. You understand.

Frank chuckles, tilting his head.

FRANK
Funny. Word is, she won't be your wife much longer. Maybe when she's single, I'll have better luck.

ALEX
Nonsense. I haven't signed a damn thing. She's still mine.

Sophia smirks and turns to Frank.

SOPHIA
The rumors are true. And when it's official, I'll be throwing a fabulous single's party. Mr.Frank, you should come.

EPISODE 54

98 **INT. UPSCALE CHARITY GALA - NIGHT** 98

The ballroom shimmers under golden light, music weaving through the chatter. A buzz ripples through the crowd—Sophia Lawrence is officially single. The sharks start circling.

SUITOR #1
(raising his glass, smirking)
To fresh starts and new opportunities. Wouldn't you agree, Miss Lawrence?

SUITOR #2
Now that you're single, Sophia… think I finally have a shot?

Across the room, Alex—trapped in a sea of elegantly dressed women—watches, jaw tightening.

SOCIALITE #1
(flirty)
Alex, care to dance with us?

SOCIALITE #2
Come on, just one.

ALEX
Ladies, if you'll excuse me—I need some air.

He strides off.

99 **INT. PRIVATE LOUNGE - NIGHT** 99

Alex pushes open the door—and stops. Sophia, sprawled across the couch, heels discarded, an empty glass dangling from her fingers. Her hair's a little messy, her cheeks flushed. She blinks up at him, then grins.

SOPHIA
(smirking, slurring slightly)
Look who finally escaped his fan club.

He crosses the room in two strides.

ALEX
You're drunk. Come on, I'll take you home.

She suddenly hooks her arms around his neck, yanking him down—close.

SOPHIA
(low, breathy)
You… are such an asshole.

Alex exhales sharply, eyes darkening.

ALEX
(gritted, voice low)
Yeah? What does that make you? Because this asshole still so damn in love with you.

And before she can answer, he crashes his lips onto hers.

EPISODE 55

100 **INT. PRIVATE LOUNGE - NIGHT** 100

Dim lighting. Clothes rumpled. Sophia and Alex, tangled in the sheets, breathless from another night of passion.

101 **LATER - MIDNIGHT** 101

Sophia stirs, eyes flickering open. Alex's arm drapes over her. She carefully lifts it, slipping out of bed.

SOPHIA (V.O.)
Sophia, what the hell is wrong with you? Get it together.

She grabs her purse, sneaking out like a thief in the night.

102 **EXT. CITY STREETS - NIGHT** 102

Sophia's car speeds down the road, her grip tight on the wheel.

103 **INT. RANDY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT** 103

Sophia creeps inside, shoes in hand. With a dramatic sigh, she face-plants onto the couch.

SOPHIA
Ugh. What the hell am I doing?!

A door creaks. Randy, wrapped in a robe, pads out, rubbing her eyes.

RANDY
Sophia? Why are you sneaking in like a teenager past curfew?

SOPHIA
Because I'm a mess! I was supposed to be done with Alex, and then—ugh!

RANDY
(smirking)
Let me guess. Things got…heated?

Sophia buries her face in a pillow.

SOPHIA
Maybe I should see a shrink.

Randy plops onto the couch beside her, running fingers through Sophia's hair.

RANDY
Look, I just think you should at least have a proper conversation with him. Maybe deep down, you don't want to leave him.

104 **INT. RANDY'S APARTMENT - MORNING** 104

Sophia picks at her breakfast when the doorbell rings.

Randy rushes in, grabbing Sophia's hands, eyes wide.

RANDY
Vivi! You won't believe what I saw! I was at the hospital with my mom and—guess who I ran into?

SOPHIA
Who?

RANDY
William. With Alex. Heading into the ER!

SOPHIA
What?!

Before Randy can react, Sophia grabs her keys and bolts for the door.

EPISODE 56

105 **INT. HOSPITAL LOBBY - DAY** 105

Sophia bursts through the entrance, eyes darting wildly. She spots the front desk, nearly collides with it.

SOPHIA
(breathless)
Christopher—where is he? What's happening?

The nurse glances at the chart, face tightening.

NURSE
Mr. Christopher suffered a severe heart attack. He's in emergency care now. The doctors are doing everything they can.

Sophia grips the edge of the counter, knuckles white.

SOPHIA
(whispers)
Heart attack…

Her stomach twists.

NURSE
The ER is down the hall—third door on the right.

Sophia barely nods before taking off, heels clicking against the tile.

106 **INT. HOSPITAL - OUTSIDE EMERGENCY ROOM - DAY** 106

A red IN PROCEDURE light glows. Sophia paces. Heart pounding. Hands clenched. Then—she stops, pressing her fingers together in a quiet, desperate prayer.

SOPHIA
(softly, shaky)
Please… don't take him. Not like this.

Her voice catches.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
I love him. I still love him. I need to tell him that!... Please, just give me one more chance.

Flashes—Alex's smirk, his hands in her hair, the way he kissed her like the world was ending. A deep inhale. Her eyes shut.

Then—warm fingers brush her shoulder. Sophia stiffens, turning—Alex. Standing. Smirking.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(stunned)
Alex?!

Her heart pounds.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
You—how—weren't you just—

EPISODE 57

107 **INT. HOSPITAL HALLWAY - DAY** 107

Alex and Sophia sit on a bench outside the ER. Alex hands her a coffee.

ALEX
It wasn't me in the ER. It was my father.

SOPHIA
Your father? What happened?

ALEX
Heart attack. Again.

Sophia softens, reaching for his arm instinctively.

SOPHIA
Alex, I—look, Lawrence Group has top cardiologists. If you need anything—

ALEX
Sophia… thank you.

SOPHIA
Just… promise me, don't wear yourself down.

She hesitates, something on the tip of her tongue. Alex notices.

ALEX
You're holding something back. What is it?

A beat. Then—

SOPHIA
I think we need to talk... about the divorce.

Alex leans in, searching her face.

ALEX
Really? You mean-you're willing to give us a second chance?!

For the first time in a long while, hope cracks through his guarded expression. He pulls his car keys from his pocket, pressing them into her hand.

ALEX (CONT'D)
Okay, umm, my car's in the garage. Go wait for me at home—we'll talk there.

Sophia hesitates, then nods.

SOPHIA
Okay. I'll see you there.

Their eyes hold for a lingering beat—so much unsaid.

108 **INT. PARKING GARAGE - DAY** 108

Sophia strides toward Alex's car, unlocking it with the fob. Her phone buzzes. She glances at the screen—Amber.

SOPHIA
(answering)
Amber?

A pause. Her face drains of color.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
What? Dad was in a car accident—?

She slams the door shut, and speeds out of the garage—tires screeching, heart pounding.

EPISODE 58

109 **INT. LAWRENCE MANSION - NIGHT** 109

Sophia storms in, breathless, eyes darting around.

SOPHIA
Dad?! It's me—I'm here!

Silence. The house is unsettlingly still. Her heels click against the marble as she rushes upstairs, flinging open doors—empty.

Her brows knit. She pulls out her phone, quickly dialing.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(low, muttering)
This doesn't feel right…Maybe they transferred him to the hospital—?

THUD. A sharp impact to the back of her head. Her phone slips from her fingers as she staggers forward.

Her vision blurs.

110 **INT. HOSPITAL - NIGHT** 110

The beep-beep-beep of a heart monitor. A doctor steps out of the OR, removing his gloves.

DOCTOR
Mr. Christopher, congratulations. The procedure was successful. Your father is stable, but he'll need 48 hours of close monitoring.

Alex nods, exhaling deeply.

ALEX
Thank you, doctor.

ALEX (CONT'D)
(to William)
Handle the rest. I need to go home.

111 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - NIGHT** 111

Alex steps inside, loosening his tie.

ALEX
Sophia?

Silence. His eyes flick toward the kitchen, the living room—empty.

A frown forms. He moves to the window, glancing at the garage.

ALEX (V.O) (CONT'D)
Weird... She didn't come back...?

He dials again. No answer.

112 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 112

A phone vibrates against a cold concrete floor. A delicate hand picks it up—Amber.

AMBER
(smirking)
Poor thing. Let's see who's coming to save you now.

She swipes decline.

Camera tilts down—Sophia, unconscious, wrists tied, a fresh bruise blooming on her temple.

EPISODE 59

113 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 113

A single flickering bulb swings from the ceiling. Sophia, wrists bound, sits in a rickety chair. She tugs at the restraints—no use.

SOPHIA
(under her breath)
Okay, Sophia. Stay calm. Think.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Amber called. Dad was in danger. I rushed home… no one was there. Then—blackout.

Her jaw clenches. Realization dawns.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(low, furious)
It was a setup.

She tilts her head toward the shadows.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
(louder)
Amber. Come out. I know it was you!

A slow, deliberate clap. Amber steps into the dim light, a satisfied smirk on her lips. Victor leans casually against the doorway, arms crossed.

AMBER
Wow. Took you long enough.

Victor saunters forward, crouching beside her, his grip tightening around her chin.

VICTOR
You really should've played this smarter, sweetheart. You could've had everything—money, power… me. But instead, you threw it all away for that pathetic cripple.

Sophia yanks her face away, eyes burning.

SOPHIA
Go to hell.

She spits at him. Victor wipes his cheek, eyes darkening.

114 **INT. ALEX'S ESTATE - NIGHT** 114

Alex grips his phone.

ALEX
William. Track Sophia's phone. I don't care what it takes—find her!

115 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 115

Amber steps closer, voice mock-sweet.

AMBER
You always have a soft spot for Daddy, didn't you?

Sophia freezes.

AMBER (CONT'D)
Well… lucky you. He's right here.

A frail figure steps forward. Mr. Lawrence.

EPISODE 60

116 **INT. EVEREST CAPITAL - WAR ROOM - NIGHT** 116

The room hums with tension. A giant screen flashes with data. Alex stands motionless, eyes locked on the map.

TECHNICIAN A
(excited, tapping the screen)
Found her! AI pinpoints a 90% probability—she's got to be here!

Alex's jaw tightens.

ALEX
Where?

TECHNICIAN B
(pointing)
An abandoned wine cellar. Close to the Lawrence mansion.

Alex doesn't hesitate.

ALEX
I'm going. William, bring back ups. Don't screw this up.

WILLIAM
(grabbing his jacket)
Don't worry, boss. We'll find her.

Alex storms out.

117 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 117

A damp, musty chill clings to the air. A single, flickering light dangles from the ceiling. Sophia, bound to a chair, breathes hard.

MR. LAWRENCE
(calm, holding out a pen)
Sign it, sweetheart.

He slides a document toward Sophia—the official stock transfer agreement for Lawrence Group. Sophia's stomach twists as she stares at the document.

SOPHIA
(voice shaking)
You're my father... How could you do this to me?

118 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 118

Sophia glares at the man she once called father, her chest rising and falling with rage.

SOPHIA
So... you and Ashely were in this together all along...?! Dad! How could you do this to me!

MR. LAWRENCE
I spent years resenting your holier-than-thou mother! And you? Just a reminder of her! Sign the damn papers, it's the only way you can walk out here alive.

Sophia's eyes skim over the text—a voluntary transfer of 90% of Lawrence Group shares to her father and Amber.

SOPHIA
(spitting)
Keep dreaming! Lawrence Corp was my mother's legacy- I'd rather burn this place down than let you parasites take it!

Ashely steps forward, her tone syrupy, but her eyes glinting with malice.

JUDY
(smirking)
My dear sister, be reasonable. You don't really have a choice.

Mr. Lawrence pulls a USB drive from his pocket, sliding it into a nearby laptop.

MR. LAWRENCE
I figured you'd be stubborn. So… here's a little incentive.

The screen flickers to life—old footage, home videos of a young Sophia and her mother, laughing, twirling,

SOPHIA
Mom…

Mr. Lawrence dangles the USB drive over the flickering flames of the fireplace.

MR. LAWRENCE
This was your mom's last gift for you. Your choice, Sophia.
(MORE)

MR. LAWRENCE (CONT'D)
Sign the contract, or say goodbye to her forever.

Sophia struggles against the ropes, her mind spinning.

MR. LAWRENCE (CONT'D)
(tightens grip)
Last chance, Sophia.

Amber leans in, voice honeyed.

AMBER
Come on, sis. Don't be stupid.

EPISODE 62

119 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 119

Sophia's hand shakes.

SOPHIA
Fine! I'll sign it!

She scrawls her signature across the contract.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
There. Happy? Now give me the damn drive!

Without a flicker of hesitation, Mr. Lawrence flicks the USB onto the ground like a piece of trash.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
No!

Amber clutches the contract, eyes gleaming with triumph. She hooks an arm around Victor, her smile sickly sweet.

AMBER
(laughs, triumphant)
Look at you—pathetic. All that crying over a worthless piece of plastic? Everything you had—your company, your life—is all mine now!

She tilts her chin up, relishing the moment, while Victor chuckles darkly beside her. Then—the door slams open. Alex steps in.

ALEX
Step away from my wife. Now!

Amber stiffens, the confidence draining from her face.

AMBER
(low, hissing)
Victor! What's he doing here! Do something!

VICTOR
(smirking)
Gladly. Time to finish what we started, cripple.

Alex charges, delivering a brutal punch, slamming Victor onto a table. He grabs Victor by the collar, pure rage in his eyes.

ALEX
I warned you, Victor—hurt Sophia, and I'll destroy you!

Victor lunges—wild, desperate. Alex dodges, shoving him back. A wine bottle teeters, then crashes to the floor. Sophia looks at the shattered glasses, an idea comes to mind.

SOPHIA
(feigning concern)
Omg! Amber, Victor looks hurt! Aren't you gonna help your man out?

Amber hesitates, eyes darting between Victor and Sophia.

EPISODE 63

120 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 120

Amber panics, eyes darting to Victor.

AMBER
Hang on, babe! I'm coming for you!

As Amber rushes to Victor, Sophia subtly grabs a shard of broken glass, frantically slicing at her ropes behind her back. Amber grabs a chair, swinging fiercely at Alex.

SOPHIA
Alex, behind you!

The chair grazes Alex as he dodges. Victor grabs a wine bottle, lunging at Alex from behind—but Sophia suddenly breaks free, tripping Victor spectacularly.

SOPHIA (CONT'D)
Not so tough now, huh?

Alex quickly pins Victor down.

ALEX
I told you... you're gonna pay for what you did.

Amber screams, charging Sophia, grabbing her hair hysterically.

AMBER
You ruined everything for me, you bitch!

Sophia shoves Amber off, slapping her hard across the face. Amber staggers, enraged, snatching the USB from the ground and flinging it toward the roaring fireplace.

AMBER (CONT'D)
Say goodbye to your dearest mommy!

Sophia's eyes widen in horror as she reaches out helplessly.

SOPHIA
No! Mom—!

EPISODE 64

121 **INT. ABANDONED WINE CELLAR - NIGHT** 121

Amber smirks, tossing the USB drive toward the blazing fireplace.

AMBER
Oops—say goodbye to Mommy's precious memories!

SOPHIA
(screaming)
No!

Alex lunges forward, snatching the USB just as flames lick his arm. He grimaces, clutching the drive tightly.

ALEX
(gritting teeth, triumphant)
Got it! Man, that's hotter than I expected.

SOPHIA
Alex! Your arm... you didn't have to—

ALEX
(gritting through pain)
Worth it, Sophia. For you.

Sophia reaches out to touch his wound.

SOPHIA
You silly! Does it hurt?

ALEX
Hey, no man is complete without a battle scar, baby.

They lock eyes.

AMBER
Victor! What are you waiting for?!

Victor moves to strike again, but suddenly the door bursts open—William storms in, followed closely by POLICE OFFICERS.

OFFICER
Hands in the air! You're under arrest for kidnapping!

Victor freezes. Amber panics. Mr. Lawrence quietly edges toward a side door, eyes darting nervously—only to be grabbed by an officer.

MR. LAWRENCE
Wait—please! This wasn't my fault! They forced me!

Sophia pulls a small recorder from her bra, holding it up with icy determination.

SOPHIA
Relax, Dad. Your confession says otherwise. I recorded every word.
(coldly)
Officers, you might want to look into my mother's death too. I have a feeling this wasn't their first crime.

Amber sinks to the floor, defeated.

AMBER
(whimpering)
Oh god... we're finished.

EPISODE 65

122 **INT. POLICE STATION - DAY** 122

Alex and Sophia exit the police station, exhausted but relieved. Alex's phone buzzes. He answers quickly.

ALEX
(into phone)
That’s amazing news! He’s awake? (beat)
Yes, of course. Let me ask her.

Alex turns, facing Sophia, carefully.

ALEX (CONT’D)
My father’s asking to see you. Would you come with me?

Sophia meets his gaze, nodding slowly.

123 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - VIP UNIT - DAY** 123

Mr. Christopher lies on the hospital bed, frail but alert. He eyes Alex and Sophia, emotions welling.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Finally, you two... I'm glad I survived to see you again.
(his tone shifts abruptly)
But what's this nonsense I'm hearing about a divorce?

Alex shifts awkwardly, looking at the floor.

ALEX
Dad, who told you that—it's complicated...

Mr. Christopher angrily grabs a pillow and flings it weakly at Alex.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Complicated? You fool! What unforgivable thing did you do? Sophia’s the best thing that ever happened to you. Screw this up, and you'll regret it forever!

He turns warmly to Sophia, softening instantly.

MR. CHRISTOPHER (CONT’D)
Sophia, if my son did something stupid, you let me know.
(MORE)

MR. CHRISTOPHER (CONT'D)
I'll straighten him out myself. But please... reconsider this divorce.

Sophia hesitates, glancing briefly at Alex, emotional.

SOPHIA
He did lie to me, Mr. Christopher. (softens) But…unfortunately, I'm still hopelessly in love with him.

ALEX
Sophia—

Sophia gently cuts him off, stepping back.

SOPHIA
I need time. Let me think about it, okay? I'll give you an answer tomorrow.

EPISODE 66

124 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - VIP UNIT - DAY** 124

Alex stands beside his father's hospital bed, face stern.

ALEX
Another thing-dad, Victor's going to prison. He kidnapped Sophia, and plotted with Amber to seize control of Christopher Corp while you were sick.

Mr. Christopher's eyes widen, voice breaking slightly.

MR. CHRISTOPHER
Oh God. All these years, I've felt guilty, favored him… protected him—and this is how he repays me?

ALEX
It's over now, Dad. You just rest. I'll handle everything from here.

Mr. Christopher nods slowly, emotional. Alex's gaze drifts toward the window, lingering on Sophia's distant figure as she walks away.

125 **INT. RANDY'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 125

Sophia sits on the edge of the bed, clutching the USB. She speaks softly to herself.

SOPHIA
Alex... you lied to me. But then you risked everything just to save Mom's memories. What am I supposed to do now?

She inserts the USB. Her mother's warm, smiling face appears on screen.

MOM (VIDEO)
Sophia, sweetheart, wherever life takes you, I just want you to be happy. And remember—true love is always worth fighting for.

Sophia's eyes fill with tears.

SOPHIA
I wish you were here, Mom. I don't know what to do...

126 **INT. ALEX'S BEDROOM - SAME NIGHT** 126

Alex tosses and turns restlessly.

ALEX
(muttering to himself)
Sophia... how are you doing? I miss you...

His phone suddenly rings, startling him. He picks up quickly.

RANDY (V.O.)
Alex! Sophia collapsed—she's at the hospital now! They said something might be wrong with the baby. Hurry!

Alex bolts upright, panic gripping his chest.

ALEX
What?!

EPISODE 67

127 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - NIGHT** 127

Sophia lies asleep, peaceful. Alex sits by her side, gently holding her hand, eyes filled with quiet longing.

ALEX
(softly)
Sophia…I screwed up, I know. But I can’t lose you—not again. I love you. Just give me one chance to start over.

Sophia's eyes flutter open slowly.

SOPHIA
Alex...? How long have you been here?

Alex grips her hand tighter, relieved beyond words. A Doctor steps into the room, smiling warmly.

DOCTOR
Glad you're awake. Everything looks good—your little one is quite the fighter—definitely inherited dad’s strength.

Sophia blinks, confused.

SOPHIA
Wait-how do you know who's the da-

Alex leans closer, voice low, playful but tender.

ALEX
Remember that night before your blind date at the hotel? You even left a note, complementing my…
(smiles mischievously)
…excellent performance?

Sophia gasps, stunned, then blushes deeply.

SOPHIA
Oh my god—it was you?

Alex nods confidently, tenderly brushing a thumb across her knuckles.

ALEX
DNA doesn’t lie. The baby is mine. And now…so are you.

He lifts her hand, gently pressing a kiss to her fingers. Sophia laughs softly, tears brimming in her eyes.

SOPHIA
I can't believe it. Our story started long before we even knew it.

Alex reaches into his pocket, pulls out a ring, then slowly sinks onto one knee.

ALEX
(earnest, heartfelt)
Sophia Lawrence, no matter what life throws at us, I will always be by your side. Loving you, protecting you, and our child, forever. Will you marry me...again?

Sophia smiles tearfully, nodding without hesitation.

SOPHIA
Yes! I do!

He slips the ring onto her finger, pulling her into a tender kiss.